

ECAS FAQ

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General

Why is the ECAS page flashing quickly?

or Why did my browser go into an infinite loop?

or Why do I have to authenticate again when connecting to my application?

The usual explanation is a web session loss due to improper cookie management. See the long explanation [here](#).

I get a Peer Not Authenticated exception

If you get the following exception:

```
javax.net.ssl.SSLPeerUnverifiedException: peer not authenticated
```

This exception is thrown when the SSL handshake is refused. The solution is to install the *right* certificates at the *right* place.

It may happen when you are using another JVM than the one you actually installed the certificates into (typically, BEA JRockit instead of Sun JDK or vice-versa).

Or also when you are not connecting directly to the ECAS server but going through a Web proxy. In that case, you need to install this proxy certificate instead.

ECAS client ships with production certificates embedded. If you are not accessing the ECAS production environment, you need to [import the certificates manually](#).

Tell me about Proxy Tickets

See [Proxy Tickets](#)

How do I import a certificate?

See [How To Import SSL Certificates](#)

How to have my application groups returned by the ECAS ticket validation response?

You need to ask the "User Access Administration" (UAA) to add your groups to Meta-Directory so that they are returned as CUD groups in ECAS validation response.

How can I logout my users from ECAS?

Short answer: You probably shouldn't logout users from ECAS.

Long answer: Killing the SSO session on ECAS has implications far beyond your application:

- the user won't be able to benefit from the SSO and will be required to retype his password for any further login on whatever ECAS protected application
- other applications won't be able to get proxy tickets for the user once he is logged out, this could impact a lot of applications working with HRS webservises for example
- it is the user choice to logout from ECAS, not the choice of a client application

The only valid reason to logout from ECAS is for application used on public booths.

If you think your application really needs log out capabilities, you can:

- Redirect the user to the ECAS URL `/cas/logout?url=<your return URL>`. The return url parameter is optional. Be aware that the user can refuse to log out.
- Participate in the Single Sign Out protocol, see chapter 18 from the advanced installation documentation.
- Enable the "renew" option in your ECAS client configuration. Be aware of the implications: this prevents SSO capabilities and is not recommended.

I have ECAS - Ajax - Session timeout problems

See [ECAS - Ajax - Session timeout](#).

Changing keystore type, a.k.a. "I have a PKCS12/JKS but I need a JKS/PKCS12"

- The free and open source software Portecle can help you: open your existing keystore and then go to Tools->Change Keystore Type, save the result.
- The `keytool` command line tool, included with java runtime, can help you as well, here is a sample command to change a PKCS12 into a JKS:

```
keytool -importkeystore -srckeystore keystore.p12 -srcstoretype PKCS12 -deststoretype JKS -destkeystore keystore.jks
```

What's the difference between a user id and a user name (a.k.a moniker)? Can I use the userid/name as primary key?

See [User id and user name distinctions](#)

What is the delay for sending the email to the self registered user?

When a user self registers (signs up on the ECAS login page), the user is created in a database (CUD). A provisioning job runs every 10 minutes to complete the registration. It is also this provision job which sends the emails.

There are also many other reasons why email can be delayed. Some are related to the sending server and some to the receiving server, and some related to obscure Internet routing issues. Even though 90% of email is delivered within a few minutes, this time-frame is not guaranteed and will not happen all the time.

How can I retrieve the user data after authentication

We once had the idea to add a convenient mechanism to obtain the current Subject (JIRA issue [ECAS-1195](#)).

We had to roll back this idea because some application servers use Principals which are not serializable. See [ECAS-1323](#) and [forum post 1285](#) for details.

The alternative is to use the User Principal from the `HttpServletRequest` or use `eu.cec.digit.ecas.client.jaas.SubjectUtil#getCurrentSubject()` if your application server is WebLogic, JBoss or GlassFish; it does not work on Tomcat.

The original discussion can be found at [forum post 1227](#).

Should I use my direct server URL or the proxy one as ECAS service URL?

See [Reverse Proxy Setup mini-FAQ](#)

WebLogic Server specific

How do I solve my `ClassCastException` with conflicting XML libraries?

E.g. Caused by: `java.lang.ClassCastException: org.apache.xerces.jaxp.SAXParserFactoryImpl cannot be cast to javax.xml.parsers.SAXParserFactory`

Do you have any jar(s) containing `javax.xml.parsers.*` classes in your application?

If yes, remove these jars from your application packaging or use a [filtering classloader](#).

ColdFusion specific

How to enable SSL debugging?

You can enable SSL debugging by using the following System properties, which you can set using the Coldfusion Administration console.

Add the following line to Server settings > Java and JVM > JVM Arguments

```
-Djavax.net.debug=ssl,handshake,trustmanager -Dssl.debug=true
```

Other

What about integration with Spring Security or Acegi?

Unfortunately we do not support Spring Security.

However if you are using RefApp, there is JCore which integrates Acegi with ECAS. Have a look at the [RefApp Wiki](#) for more information. ([ECAS + Spring Security Page](#))

If not, you may want to look into J2EE container Authentication for Spring Security. Some links which may help:

- <http://static.springsource.org/spring-security/site/docs/3.0.x/reference/preauth.html#d0e5839>
- <http://stackoverflow.com/questions/9831268/how-to-use-j2eeauthenticatedprocessingfilter-and-a-custom-authentication-prov>

add a convenient mechanism to obtain the current Subject authenticated using ECAS

And what about integration with Pac4j?

The following post shows a sample CAS configuration for Pac4j using Spring WebMVC. It also draws a comparison with Spring Security.

<http://www.pac4j.org/blog/spring-boot-security-choose-spring-webmvc-pac4j.html>